

RAMCO VIDYA MANDIR SR. SEC. SCHOOL, THAMARAIKULAM
CLASS 12 ENGLISH REVISION – PR6 POETS AND PANCAKES

Marks :

Name :

Duration :

Exam No. :

Section A: Extract Based Comprehension (3 x 5 = 15 marks)

Extract (1):

"The make-up department of the Gemini Studios was actually a gang of nationally integrated men. They could be from anywhere, and they could be anyone. But they all wore a uniform: a khaki shirt and khaki trousers."

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What does the phrase “nationally integrated men” imply in the passage?

- (a) They were all from the same city
- (b) They belonged to different regions of India
- (c) They were foreigners working in India
- (d) They were part of the armed forces

Answer: (b) They belonged to different regions of India

Q2: What was the common attire of the make-up department staff?

- (a) White shirts and black trousers
- (b) Jeans and T-shirts
- (c) Khaki shirts and khaki trousers
- (d) Traditional Indian wear

Answer: (c) Khaki shirts and khaki trousers

2. Assertion-Reasoning Questions

Q3: Assertion: The make-up department at Gemini Studios was a symbol of national integration.

Reason: The staff came from various parts of India and worked together in harmony.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true.

Answer: (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

Q4: Assertion: The uniform of the make-up department was khaki.

Reason: It was a symbol of their creative freedom.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true.

Answer: (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.

3. Fill in the Blanks

Q5: The make-up department staff wore a _____ uniform, which added to their collective identity.

Answer: khaki

4. Choose the Words and Pick the Right Choice

Q6: Which word best describes the tone used by the author to describe the make-up department?

- (a) Sympathetic • (b) Humorous • (c) Critical • (d) Formal

Answer: (b) Humorous

Extract 2

"The people of the department wore a khaki uniform and spent their days applying pancake to the faces of actors and actresses. The make-up room had mirrors surrounded by lights, and the air was thick with the smell of cosmetics. The author, a young writer at the time, observed the hierarchy in the make-up department — the chief make-up man attended to the lead actors, his senior assistant to the second lead, and so on, until the junior-most apprentice dealt with the crowd. The author humorously noted that the make-up department was a symbol of national integration, with people from different parts of India working together in a small room filled with greasepaint and gossip."

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What was the primary task of the make-up department at Gemini Studios?

- (a) Designing costumes
- (b) Writing film scripts
- (c) Applying cosmetics to actors
- (d) Directing scenes

Answer: (c) Applying cosmetics to actors

Q2: What does the passage suggest about the hierarchy in the make-up department?

- (a) Everyone had equal responsibilities
- (b) Tasks were assigned based on experience and rank
- (c) Only the chief did all the work
- (d) The junior-most handled the lead actors

Answer: (b) Tasks were assigned based on experience and rank

Q3: What does the author mean by “symbol of national integration”?

- (a) The department followed government rules
- (b) It had members from various Indian states
- (c) It promoted Indian culture
- (d) It was a political organization

Answer: (b) It had members from various Indian states

Q4: What tone does the author use to describe the make-up room?

- (a) Critical and harsh
- (b) Humorous and observant
- (c) Sentimental and nostalgic
- (d) Formal and detached

Answer: (b) Humorous and observant

Q5: What filled the air of the make-up room?

- (a) Perfume and incense
- (b) Dust and paint
- (c) Greasepaint and gossip
- (d) Music and laughter

Answer: (c) Greasepaint and gossip

2. Assertion-Reasoning Questions

Q6: Assertion: The make-up room at Gemini Studios was a place of cultural diversity.

Reason: It employed people from different regions of India.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true.

Answer: (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion

Q7: Assertion: The junior-most apprentice handled the lead actors.

Reason: He was the most skilled in the department.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true.

Answer: (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false

3. Fill in the Blanks

Q8: The make-up department followed a strict _____, with each member attending to actors based on their rank. **Answer:** hierarchy

Q9: The author described the make-up room as being filled with _____ and gossip.

Answer: greasepaint

4. Choose the Words and Pick the Right Choice

Q10: Which word best describes the author's attitude towards the make-up department?

- (a) Reverent • (b) Humorous • (c) Disgusted • (d) Indifferent **Answer:** (b) Humorous

Extract 3

"The great prose-writers of the world may not admit it, but prose-writing is not and cannot be the true pursuit of a genius. It is for the patient, persistent and the undemanding. The Gemini Studios was a place where prose was not just written but lived. The people who worked there — from the make-up men to the office boys — had stories, quirks, and philosophies that made the place a microcosm of India. The author, who was a part of the story department, found himself surrounded by poets who could recite verses but struggled to write coherent prose. Ironically, the studio's attempt to bring literary sophistication through the visit of an English editor only deepened the confusion."

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: According to the author, prose-writing requires:

- (a) Genius and flair
- (b) Patience and persistence
- (c) Wealth and fame
- (d) Artistic temperament

Answer: (b) Patience and persistence

Q2: What does the author imply about the poets at Gemini Studios?

- (a) They were excellent prose writers
- (b) They were uninterested in literature
- (c) They struggled with writing coherent prose
- (d) They were film directors

Answer: (c) They struggled with writing coherent prose

Q3: What does the author mean by “prose was not just written but lived”?

- (a) Everyone at the studio was a published author
- (b) The studio was filled with real-life stories and characters
- (c) The studio produced only prose films
- (d) The staff followed literary rules strictly

Answer: (b) The studio was filled with real-life stories and characters

Q4: What was ironic about the visit of the English editor?

- (a) He was fluent in Tamil
- (b) He was mistaken for a poet
- (c) His presence created more confusion than clarity
- (d) He refused to speak at the studio

Answer: (c) His presence created more confusion than clarity

Q5: What does the passage suggest about the environment at Gemini Studios?

- (a) It was strictly professional
- (b) It was culturally diverse and intellectually rich
- (c) It lacked creativity
- (d) It was focused only on commercial success

Answer: (b) It was culturally diverse and intellectually rich

Section B: Short Answer Questions (12 x 2 = 24 marks)

Story-Based Questions (3 × 2 Marks = 6 Marks)

Q1. Why does the author describe the make-up department as a symbol of national integration?

Answer: The make-up department at Gemini Studios had staff from various regions of India, working together in harmony. This diversity reflected the idea of national integration, where people of different backgrounds contributed to a shared creative space. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the diversity of staff
- 1 mark for linking it to national integration

Q2. How did the hierarchy in the make-up room reflect the studio’s functioning? **Answer:** The chief make-up man handled the lead actors, while assistants attended to supporting roles and the apprentice worked on the crowd. This structured hierarchy mirrored the studio’s

organized yet rigid functioning, where roles were clearly defined based on rank. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for describing the hierarchy
- 1 mark for explaining its reflection of studio structure

Q3. What was ironic about the Englishman's visit to Gemini Studios? **Answer:** The Englishman was expected to enlighten the staff with literary insights, but his speech was incomprehensible to most. Ironically, instead of bridging cultural gaps, his visit deepened confusion, highlighting the disconnect between Western literary ideals and the studio's reality.

Marking Scheme:

- 1 mark for stating the irony
- 1 mark for explaining the cultural disconnect

Value-Based Questions (3 × 2 Marks = 6 Marks)

Q4. What values are reflected in the boss's treatment of poets at Gemini Studios? **Answer:** The boss's generosity and admiration for poetry reflect values of compassion, artistic respect, and cultural inclusivity. By offering poets shelter and food, he nurtured creativity, even if it didn't directly benefit the studio's commercial goals. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying values (generosity, respect)
- 1 mark for explaining how they were reflected

Q5. How does the author's tone contribute to the value of humility in the narrative? **Answer:** The author uses a humorous and self-effacing tone, portraying himself as a quiet observer rather than a central figure. This humility allows readers to appreciate the ordinary people and events that shaped the studio's culture, emphasizing the value of modesty. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the tone
- 1 mark for linking it to humility

Q6. What lesson can be drawn from the confusion surrounding the English editor's speech? **Answer:** The incident teaches that communication must consider the audience's context. Intellectual elitism without accessibility leads to alienation. The editor's failure to connect shows the importance of clarity and empathy in cross-cultural exchanges. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for stating the lesson
- 1 mark for explaining its relevance

Competency-Based Questions (4 × 2 Marks = 8 Marks)

Q7. How does the author use observation to build character sketches in the chapter? **Answer:** The author keenly observes the quirks and routines of studio staff, from the gossiping make-up men to the silent office boy. These details help build vivid character sketches that reflect the studio's social dynamics. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying observation as a tool
- 1 mark for explaining its effect on characterization

Q8. What does the author's experience at Gemini Studios reveal about the gap between literary ideals and practical realities? **Answer:** The author's experience shows that while literary ideals were admired, they often clashed with the studio's commercial and cultural limitations. The visit of the English editor exemplifies this gap, as his intellectual discourse failed to resonate with the staff. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the gap
- 1 mark for citing an example

Q9. How does the setting of the make-up room contribute to the theme of illusion in cinema?

Answer: The make-up room, filled with mirrors and cosmetics, symbolizes the illusion central to cinema. It transforms ordinary people into glamorous stars, reinforcing the idea that film is a crafted reality, not a reflection of truth. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for describing the setting
- 1 mark for linking it to the theme of illusion

Q10. In what way does the author's role as a writer influence his perspective on studio life?

Answer: As a writer, the author views studio life with curiosity and detachment. His literary lens allows him to notice subtle details and ironies, offering a reflective and nuanced portrayal of the people and practices at Gemini Studios. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying his role
- 1 mark for explaining its influence on perspective

Literary Device-Based Questions (2 × 2 Marks = 4 Marks)

Q11. Identify and explain the use of irony in the chapter. **Answer:** Irony is evident in the English editor's visit, where a literary figure meant to inspire instead confuses the audience. The expectation of enlightenment is subverted, highlighting the gap between intention and impact.

Marking Scheme:

- 1 mark for identifying irony
- 1 mark for explaining its effect

Q12. What is the significance of the metaphor "greasepaint and gossip" in the chapter?

Answer: The metaphor "greasepaint and gossip" captures the dual nature of studio life — the artificial glamour of cinema and the human element of chatter and camaraderie. It reflects the blend of illusion and reality behind the scenes. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the metaphor
- 1 mark for interpreting its significance

Section C: Long Answer Questions

1. Theme-Based Question

Q: Discuss the theme of illusion versus reality in *Poets and Pancakes*.

Answer: In *Poets and Pancakes*, Asokamitran explores the theme of illusion versus reality through the workings of Gemini Studios. The make-up room, filled with mirrors and cosmetics, becomes a metaphor for the artificial world of cinema, where appearances are crafted and reality is concealed.

The hierarchy in the make-up department, the transformation of actors, and the confusion during the English editor's visit all highlight the contrast between what is seen and what truly exists. The editor's speech, expected to enlighten, instead confuses the audience—revealing the gap between intellectual ideals and practical understanding.

Through subtle humour and irony, the author shows that behind the glamour of films lies a world of routine, hierarchy, and miscommunication. The theme reminds readers that cinema, like life, often presents illusions that mask deeper truths.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Introduction of theme
- 2 marks: Textual examples and analysis
- 1 mark: Interpretation and insight
- 1 mark: Coherent conclusion

2. Value-Based Question

Q: What values are reflected in the functioning of Gemini Studios?

Answer: Gemini Studios, as portrayed by Asokamitran, reflects values of inclusivity, generosity, and respect for creativity. The make-up department, with staff from various regions of India, symbolizes national integration and cultural harmony.

The boss's admiration for poetry and his support for poets—even when their work had little relevance to filmmaking—demonstrate compassion and artistic respect. The studio nurtured creativity and provided space for intellectual engagement, even if it didn't align with commercial goals. The author's respectful portrayal of ordinary workers also reflects humility and empathy.

These values create a unique environment where art and humanity coexist. Asokamitran's narrative encourages readers to appreciate diversity, kindness, and the quiet contributions of everyday people in creative spaces.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Identification of values
- 2 marks: Supporting examples from the text
- 1 mark: Relevance to broader context
- 1 mark: Conclusion with reflection

3. Article-Based Question

Q: Write an article on “The Role of Humour in Literary Non-Fiction” using *Poets and Pancakes* as reference.

Answer: Humour in literary non-fiction serves to engage readers while offering deeper insights. In *Poets and Pancakes*, Asokamitran uses gentle irony and wit to describe life at Gemini Studios. His humorous tone makes complex ideas accessible and highlights the absurdities of daily life. Whether it's the make-up room hierarchy or the confusion during the English editor's visit, humour helps reveal the human side of the film industry. It allows the author to critique without being harsh and to celebrate ordinary people with warmth. Thus, humour becomes a powerful tool in non-fiction, making narratives relatable and reflective. Asokamitran's style shows that truth can be told with a smile.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Introduction of concept
- 2 marks: Examples from the chapter
- 1 mark: Analysis of impact
- 1 mark: Conclusion with relevance

4. Speech-Based Question

Q: Imagine you are a student speaking on “Cinema and Society.” Prepare a speech using references from *Poets and Pancakes*.

Answer: Good morning everyone. Today I’d like to speak on “Cinema and Society,” using *Poets and Pancakes* as a reference. Cinema is more than entertainment—it reflects and shapes our values, aspirations, and social realities.

In the chapter, Asokamitran presents Gemini Studios as a microcosm of Indian society. The make-up room, filled with people from different regions, symbolizes national integration. The studio’s admiration for poetry and literature shows how cinema engages with cultural ideals. Yet, the confusion during the English editor’s visit reveals the gap between intellectual ambition and practical understanding.

Cinema influences society by portraying dreams and dilemmas, but it also depends on society’s diversity and creativity. As students, we must learn to appreciate both the glamour and the grit behind the screen. Thank you.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Clear opening and relevance of topic
- 2 marks: Use of textual references and examples
- 1 mark: Personal insight or reflection
- 1 mark: Effective conclusion

5. Story-Based Question

Q: Narrate a short story inspired by the make-up room at Gemini Studios.

Answer: Ravi, a shy apprentice in the make-up room, spent his days applying pancake to extras. He admired the chief make-up man, who worked on stars, and dreamed of proving himself.

One day, a famous actress requested Ravi’s help when the chief was absent. Nervous but determined, Ravi did her make-up with care and precision. Impressed, she praised him publicly. The studio boss noticed and promoted Ravi to assistant. Over time, Ravi became the chief himself, mentoring young apprentices with kindness.

His journey from the crowd to the spotlight reflected the silent dreams nurtured in the make-up room. It showed that talent and humility can shine even in the background.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Creative and relevant opening
- 2 marks: Development with reference to the chapter
- 1 mark: Emotional or thematic depth
- 1 mark: Satisfying conclusion

6. Author’s Point of View Question

Q: How does Asokamitran’s point of view shape the narrative in *Poets and Pancakes*?

Answer: Asokamitran writes from the perspective of a quiet observer, which gives the narrative its unique tone. He doesn’t glorify or criticize; instead, he presents events with subtle humour and irony.

His point of view allows readers to see the contradictions of studio life—the glamour versus the grind, the intellectual aspirations versus practical limitations. By focusing on ordinary

people like the make-up men and office boys, he elevates their stories and gives voice to the unseen. His detachment helps readers form their own opinions without being influenced by bias.

This perspective makes the chapter relatable and reflective. It encourages readers to look beyond appearances and appreciate the everyday realities behind the cinematic illusion.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Identification of point of view
- 2 marks: Examples from the text
- 1 mark: Impact on narrative tone and structure
- 1 mark: Conclusion with interpretation

7. Diary Entry-Based Question

Q: Imagine you are the author. Write a diary entry after the English editor's visit.

Answer: Dear Diary, Today was puzzling. The English editor from *The Encounter* visited Gemini Studios. We expected literary brilliance, but his speech was baffling. Most of us couldn't follow a word.

I sat quietly, wondering if the fault lay in our understanding or his delivery. The boss looked disappointed, and the poets were silent. It felt like a missed opportunity to connect with global literary thought. Yet, it reminded me how disconnected intellectual elitism can be from everyday reality.

Still, I'm grateful for the experience. It taught me that communication must be rooted in empathy, not just intellect. Perhaps we need more bridges, not walls, between cultures.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Authentic voice and diary format
- 2 marks: Reference to the event and emotional response
- 1 mark: Reflective insight or learning
- 1 mark: Thoughtful conclusion